

## 24STCV12651 24STCV12651

County: los-angeles

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### MOTION TO SEAL

The Court tenders the following tentative ruling in the matter Christin Sporny v. Mendocino Farms, LLC, et al., Los Angeles County Superior Court case number 24STCV12651, set for hearing on July 13, 2026. Christin Sporny (Plaintiff) moves for an order sealing all records in this case. The motion is unopposed. The motion is denied.

A.

#### Legal Standard

Pursuant to

California Rule of Court, rule 2.550(d), the court may order that a record be sealed if it finds facts that establish the following: (1) There exists an overriding interest that overcomes the right of public access to the record; (2) The overriding interest supports sealing the record; (3) A substantial probability exists that the overriding interest will be prejudiced if the record is not sealed; (4) The proposed sealing is narrowly tailored; and (5) No less restrictive means exist to achieve the overriding interest.

A “reasoned decision about sealing

or unsealing records cannot be made without . . . (1) identifying the specific information claimed to be entitled to such treatment; (2) identifying the nature of the harm threatened by disclosure; and (3) identifying and accounting for countervailing considerations. The burden of presenting information sufficient to accomplish the first two steps is logically placed on the party seeking the sealing of the documents, who is presumptively in the best position to know what disclosures will harm and how.” (H.B. Fuller Co. v. Doe (2007) 151 Cal.App.4th 879, 894.) The burden

of showing there are less restrictive means of achieving the overriding interest lies with one who is seeking disclosure of the allegedly confidential information. (NBC Subsidiary (KNBC-TV), Inc. v. Superior Court (1999) 20 Cal.4th 1178, 1224.)

B.

Discussion

Plaintiff has met all the requirements for sealing under rule 2.550(d). First, Plaintiff demonstrates that there is an overriding interest in sealing the records in this case because the present lawsuit is readily searchable by potential employers and she suspects that they are refusing to hire her after discovering it. Second, she argues that this interest supports sealing the records because she should be able to obtain employment in her field. Third, Plaintiff argues that she will suffer prejudice if the records remain unsealed.

However, Plaintiff has not demonstrated that the proposed sealing is narrowly tailored. She admits as much in her motion. Indeed, Plaintiff requests the sealing of all records in this case, regardless of whether they pertain to the substance of her claims or not. Yet even this measure will not achieve the result Plaintiff seeks, in that the mere existence of the present case will remain public knowledge. There are rare cases in which a narrowly tailored sealing order includes sealing the entire record. (In re M.T. (2024) 106 Cal.App.5th 322, 346.) But Plaintiff has not demonstrated that this is such a case. Accordingly, Plaintiff's motion is denied.

Conclusion:

The Court denies  
the motion.